

VIM CHEAT SHEET

DevOps Bootcamp quick reference · works in **Vim** & **LazyVim** / **Neovim**
Lost? Press **Esc** to return to **NORMAL** mode and look at the bottom line.

The mental model — Vim is a language: **verb + motion**. The verb says what to do, the motion says where. **d**=delete **c**=change **y**=yank(copy)
→ **d w** delete a word, **c \$** change to end of line, **y y** yank a line. Double the verb to act on the whole line.

THE 4 MODES

Esc → NORMAL (commands). Home base.
i → INSERT (type text)
v → VISUAL (select text)
: → COMMAND (e.g. **:w**)

SAVE & QUIT

:w write (save)
:q quit
:wq / **ZZ** save and quit
:q! quit, discard changes (escape hatch)
:wqa save & quit all windows

MOVE THE CURSOR

h j k l left / down / up / right
w / **b** next word / back a word
e end of word
0 / **\$** start / end of line
^ first non-blank char
gg / **G** top / bottom of file
:42 go to line 42
{ / **}** prev / next paragraph
Ctrl + **d** half-page down (**u** = up)

ENTER INSERT MODE

i / **a** insert before / after cursor
I / **A** start / end of line
o / **O** open new line below / above
Esc leave insert mode

DELETE

x delete one character
dw delete to next word
dd delete whole line
d\$ / **D** delete to end of line
3dd delete 3 lines (number + cmd)

CHANGE / REPLACE

cw change a word
C change to end of line
cc change the whole line
r + **ch** replace one character
s substitute char & type
~ toggle upper/lower case

TEXT OBJECTS (verb + i/a + target)

ci" change inside the quotes
di{ delete inside the { }
ciw change inner word (cursor anywhere on it)
yi{ yank inside the { }
i=inside, **a**=around (includes the brackets)

UNDO / REDO / REPEAT

u undo
Ctrl + **r** redo
. repeat last change (superpower)

COPY (YANK) & PASTE

yy yank (copy) a line
yw yank a word
p / **P** paste after / before
delete also copies, so **dd ... p** = cut & paste

VISUAL MODE

v select characters
V select whole lines
Ctrl + **v** BLOCK (column) select
then **d y >** delete / yank / indent selection
Block + **I ... Esc** edits every selected line at once

SEARCH

/ text search forward
? text search backward
n / **N** next / previous match
***** search word under cursor
:noh clear search highlight

SEARCH & REPLACE

:%s/old/new/g replace all in file
:%s/old/new/gc...confirm each (y/n/a/q)
:s/old/new/g replace on current line
% = all lines · **g** = every match on a line

LAZYMIM ESSENTIALS

Space leader key — pops up which-key menu
Space e file explorer (neo-tree)
Space f f find file by name
Space / search text across project
Space w window/split commands
:Lazy open plugin manager
Ctrl + **e** dismiss the completion popup
Auto-pairs adds the closing **)** **"** for you — that's normal.

When in doubt: **press Esc**, then read the bottom-left of the screen to see what mode you're in.

Try it built-in: run **:Tutor** (Neovim) or **vimtutor** in the shell for a 30-min guided lesson.